

Annual Influenza Information & Consent Form

As a healthcare professional, you may have exposure to the influenza virus. You can either **consent** to or **decline** the vaccination but you must complete this form to assure that if you remain unvaccinated, you have personally declined the vaccine and agree to wear a N95 respirator or surgical mask for the duration of your shift, if required. Please read the influenza information and complete this form with signature and date.

What is Influenza ("Flu")

Influenza is an infection caused by a virus that affects the upper and lower respiratory systems. The symptoms are usually fever, chills, body aching, sore throat, and cough. There are two main types of influenza viruses, Influenza A and B. Within each main type there are many sub-types. All the influenza viruses cause the same general type of symptoms. Different types will be more common in different years or in different countries. In the United States, influenza activity generally peaks between late December to March.

What is the Vaccine?

There are two types of vaccine. Injectable and nasal spray. This information applies to the injectable one. The injectable vaccine is made from inactivated virus. The vaccine does not cause the flu. It works by raising the body's immunity toward the specific viruses that are contained in the vaccine. Influenza viruses are always changing. The vaccine is updated yearly to protect against the viruses predicted to be present in that flu season. The vaccine is quite effective against infection and if a vaccinated person should become infected, the illness will be milder. There is also a live attenuated vaccine which is administered as a nasal spray. It takes about two weeks after the vaccine before it is effective, and the immunity lasts at least six months.

☐ **Consent**

I have been informed about and offered the opportunity to receive the influenza vaccine, at no charge to myself. I understand that it is my responsibility to schedule to have the vaccination with either my healthcare provider or with the healthcare facility prior to any direct contact with patients. As with any medical treatment, there is no guarantee that I will become immune or that I will not experience any adverse side effect from the vaccine. The vaccine takes about two weeks to reach maximum protection. Therefore, I will not be fully protected from catching the flu until that time. I accept the offer and provide the following information: (If the vaccine has already been obtained please attach documentation or have the administrator of the vaccine complete the information below)

Name: _____ Date: _____ Signature: _____

Route: _____ Manufacturer: _____ Lot No: _____ Site of Administration: _____

Date Vaccination Given: _____ Administered By: _____ Signature: _____

☐ **Decline**

I understand that due to my occupational exposure to respiratory illnesses, I may be at risk of acquiring Influenza infection. I have been given the opportunity to be vaccinated with the influenza vaccine, at no charge to me. I am aware that I cannot get the influenza disease from the influenza vaccine. I can be infected by the influenza virus but not feel ill for 24-48 hours before symptoms appear, and I can pass the virus to vulnerable patients who are at risk of complications or death from influenza. I can also pass the virus to my family, friends and co-workers. Influenza strains change every year and an immunization received in prior years does not usually provide immunity to this year's strain of influenza. Despite these facts, I am choosing to decline the influenza vaccination right now because:

- ☐ I have already received influenza vaccine and have provided documentation
- ☐ I believe I will get the flu if I get the shot.
- ☐ I do not like needles.
- ☐ My philosophical or religious beliefs prohibit vaccination.
- ☐ I have a medical contraindication to receiving the vaccine.
- ☐ Other reason – please tell us. _____
- ☐ I do not wish to say why I decline.

Based on the requirements of your assignment location or facility:

I understand that if I choose to decline the influenza vaccine, and my job duties may cause me to infect patients or to become infected, I may be required to wear a N95 respirator or surgical mask for the duration of my shift. Failure to wear a N95 respirator or surgical mask during duty will result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination. I understand that I may change my mind at any time and accept the influenza vaccination, if the vaccine is available. I understand that if I decline the vaccine AND refuse to wear a N95 respirator or surgical mask, I am voluntarily resigning my position. I have read and fully understand the information on this form. Furthermore, this is to certify that I have been provided information at a minimum, the influenza vaccine; non-vaccine control and prevention measures; and the diagnosis, transmission and impact of influenza.

Name: _____ Signature: _____ Date: _____